PRACTITIONER PROTOCOL

Manicure & E-File

Follow your state board rules on cuticle work and your e-file maker's instructions. Times are typical.

SCREEN

Intake cleared. No infection, fungus, open cuts or eczema flare. Nail folds not red or swollen.

CHECK

Diabetes, blood thinners or chemo: gentlest care, no cutting, physician OK before e-file work.

PRE-CARE SENT

Arrive with clean nails. Don't cut, pick or bite cuticles before the visit.

SET UP FIRST ☐ Hands washed, gloves on ☐ Bits cleaned and disinfected ☐ New sanding band, file, buffer ☐ Disinfected nippers, pusher ☐ E-file checked, speed low ☐ Dust collector, gauze, antiseptic

#	STEP	TIME	HOW
1	**Consult & screen**	10 min	Check hands, nail folds and plates in good light. Confirm health changes.
2	**Consent & photos**	5 min	Consent signed. Before photos. Note cuticle and nail plate condition.
3	**Sanitize & remove**	5 min	Client washes or sanitizes hands. Remove polish fully.
4	**Shape**	5 min	180+ grit file, light strokes. Length and shape as agreed.
5	**Lift cuticle**	3 min	Push back the eponychium gently. Lift non-living cuticle off the plate.
6	**E-file cuticle**	10 min	Trained tech only. Fine safety bit, low-moderate speed, keep it moving.
7	**Tidy**	5 min	Nip only loose, non-living tissue. Never cut living skin.
8	**Inspect**	2 min	Good light: look for hangnails, redness or nicks. Buff edges smooth.
9	**Cleanse**	2 min	Brush off dust. Wipe plates to remove oils before any polish.
10	**Finish**	10 min	Base, polish and top coat, or buff to shine. Oil once polish is dry.
11	**Aftercare & rebook**	5 min	Review sheet and card. Book in [2–4] weeks. Bits to cleaning.

ENDPOINT AND SAFETY

- Clean cuticle line, no redness, no broken skin
- Heat felt? Lift off, slow down, lighten touch
- Never use coarse bits on the natural nail plate
- Disinfect bits after every client, or new band

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Nick or bleeding: stop, fresh gloves, firm pressure with sterile gauze.
- Bag gauze and contaminated items in a sealed bag, then discard.
- Heat spike or burning: lift the bit, let the nail cool, lower speed.
- Once it stops: antiseptic and a bandage. No product over broken skin.
- Clean and disinfect bits, tools and station before you continue.
- Overfiled or thin spot: stop filing there and note it on the record.

Redness, swelling, warmth or pus later: refer to a physician. Write an incident report.

RECORD FOR THIS SESSION

E-file · bits used	Speed (RPM)	Bits disinfected · band	Cuticle condition
Nail plate notes	**Polish · lot**	**Nicks · first aid**	**Next visit · initials**